

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

Host: Williamsburg Township

**Meeting was called to order:** Meeting called to order by Bob Hausermann at 6:16 PM with the following CCTA Officers & Active Members in attendance:

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Bob Hausermann

Jackson Township:

Trustee Joe Speeg

Monroe Township:

Trustee Tom Peck

Miami Township:

Trustee Mary Makley Wolff

Monroe Township:

Trustee Tom Peck

Ohio Township:

Trustee Rick Hinson

Trustee-Elect Joel Gilpin

Trustee-Elect Scott Wolf

Fiscal Officer Bill Gilpin

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice President Allen Freeman

Tate Township:

Fiscal Officer Kathy Brannock

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Fiscal Officer Ron Campbell

Washington Township:

Trustee Dennis Cooper

Trustee-Elect Rob Laubach

Wayne Township:

Trustee / OTA Exec. Committee Member Teresa Hinnars

Williamsburg Township:

Trustee Bari Henning

Trustee Gary Jordan

Trustee Guy Bainum

Trustee-Elect Charlie Maklem

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

The Pledge of Allegiance was led by Guy Bainum, and a prayer was offered by Associate Member Bob McGee.

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

Mr. Hausermann thanked Williamsburg Township for hosting this evening's meeting, and for the dinner ready to be served. He turned the floor over to Mr. Guy Bainum. Mr. Bainum announced that the food was ready. Meeting was adjourned to dinner at approximately 6:18 PM. At approximately 6:45 PM, Mr. Hausermann called the meeting back to order.

Mr. Hausermann again offered thanks to Williamsburg Township for the wonderful Thanksgiving Dinner they provided again this year. Mr. Hausermann then announced it was time for some real business, and recapped that it has been an unusual year as far as membership in the CCTA goes. We've had few retirements, and some that had elections affect their ability to serve. Mr. Hausermann stated that he had a couple of certificates that he would like to present on behalf of the CCCTA.

Mr. Hausermann asked Mr. Bari Henning to step forward. Mr. Hausermann read that on behalf of the Clermont County Township Association this Certificate of Special Recognition is hereby presented to the Honorable Bari Henning in recognition of his professional excellence and for his many years of service as a Williamsburg Township Trustee.

Mr. Hausermann asked Mr. Rick Hinson to step forward, acknowledging that he has served as a Trustee of Ohio Township for 32 years. Mr. Hausermann read that on behalf of the Clermont County Township Association this Certificate of Special Recognition is hereby presented to the Honorable Rick Hinson in recognition of his professional excellence and for his many years of service as an Ohio Township Trustee.

Mr. Hausermann stated that he also had a certificate for Mr. Jim Sauls who was unfortunately not able to attend tonight's meeting. Mr. Hausermann read that on behalf of the Clermont County Township Association this Certificate of Special Recognition is hereby presented to the Honorable Jim Sauls, Jr. in recognition of his professional excellence and for his many years of service as a Batavia Township Trustee. Mr. Hausermann stated that we will be sure to get this certificate delivered to Mr. Sauls.

### **CCTA Business:**

Mr. Hausermann then announced that it is the time of year that we have our Annual Officer's meeting. Mr. Hausermann opened the floor for nominations for President of the CCTA for 2026. Mr. Hausermann nominated Mr. Allen Freeman for President and asked for a second. Ms. Hinnners seconded the nomination. There being no other nominations, Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to close nominations. Mr. Cooper moved to close nominations, seconded by Mr. Becker. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote of all in favor to state "Aye", and for all opposed. With Mr. Freeman as the sole "No", Mr. Freeman was elected by the majority of Active Members present as President of the Clermont County Township Association for 2026.

Mr. Hausermann opened the floor for nominations for Vice President of the CCTA for 2026. Mr. Freeman nominated Mr. Bob Hausermann for Vice President. Mr. Bainum seconded the nomination of Mr. Hausermann. Mr. Cooper moved to close nominations, seconded by Mr. Becker. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote of all in favor to state "Aye", and for all opposed. With Mr. Hausermann voting "No", Mr. Hausermann was elected by the majority of Active Members present as Vice President of the Clermont County Township Association for 2026.

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

Mr. Hausermann opened the floor for nominations for the OTA Executive Committee Member from the CCTA for 2026. Mr. Guy Bainum nominated Ms. Teresa Hinnners, seconded by Mr. Rick Hinson. Mr. Hausermann asked for any other nominations, and hearing none Mr. Hausermann announced that nominations were closed. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote of all in favor to state "Aye", and for all opposed. With Ms. Hinnners as the sole "No", Ms. Hinnners was elected by the majority of Active Members present as OTA Executive Committee Member of the Clermont County Township Association for 2026.

Mr. Hausermann stated that we now need to select the representative to the 911 Commission. Mr. Hausermann stated that we have normally kept this position with the President, but it is up to the CCTA to decide if they would like to keep it that way this year. Mr. Hausermann reminded the members that we have a 911 Officer and recapped what the responsibilities are for this position. A representative is required by the state from the townships that do not have their own entity [911 System/Dispatch]. Mr. Hausermann again recapped that this has always been a responsibility of the CCTA President. Mr. Hausermann stated that we can either keep it this way or elect someone different. Mr. Cooper moved to retain this as a responsibility of the President, Mr. Bainum seconded. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote with all in favor to state "Aye", and for all opposed. Motion carried without opposition to retain the representative to the 911 Commission with the President of the CCTA.

Mr. Hausermann then called for a Treasurer's Report.

Treasurer: Mr. Baird reviewed the November 2025 Treasurer's report for the period October 1 through October 31, 2025. The opening balance was \$4,218.49. Deposits of \$55.00 with details of what those deposits were. The ending balance closed the month at \$4,273.49. Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to approve the Treasurer's report. Motion to accept the Treasurer's report by Ms. Hinnners, seconded by Mr. Jordan. A third was also provided by Mr. Becker. Carried without opposition.

Secretary: Mr. Hausermann called for the Secretary's minutes for review and approval. Mr. Hausermann reminded the members that Mr. Baird had emailed members drafts of the minutes and asked if they had been reviewed. Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to approve the minutes, unless there is anyone that would like a reading of the minutes. Mr. Baird stated that he had made one correction to the minutes for the September 18<sup>th</sup> meeting after Mr. Hinson had pointed out an error. Mr. Baird had incorrectly listed Mr. Hinson for the motion to adjourn but Mr. Hinson was not present at that meeting.

Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to approve the minutes. Mr. Peck moved to approve the minutes as corrected, seconded by Rick Hinson. Mr. Hausermann clarified that the motion is to approve the minutes of Sept. 18<sup>th</sup> and October 16<sup>th</sup> that we had combined them together into one. Carried without opposition.

### **Sub-Committee Activity:**

Mr. Hausermann asked if Mr. Freeman had any Finance Sub-Committee activity he would like to present. Mr. Freeman stated that he didn't have a whole lot. He reported that the House and Senate have come together on a bill to reform property taxes, which will hit townships' inside millage and will affect things

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

like the homestead exemption and other deductions like that. It will primarily affect schools, but will hit townships the hardest with inside millage.

Mr. Freeman relayed additional information about taxation and the debate on property taxes, and legislation that is moving its way through the general assembly. Mr. Freeman stated he would be collecting more information about these topics and post it to the webpage so members can take a look at it.

Mr. Cooper brought up the bill that is moving to raise the vote requirement to 60% for passage of any new levy. Debate followed among members about the likelihood that it passes the legislature, and the impact that would have on the success rate of future levies. Members compared results of recent levels in comparison to the proposed legislation. Members also discussed where our local representatives may stand on their support or opposition to that type of change.

The group also discussed details of some recent votes, and the votes our representatives have made on some major financial allocations. Concerns were expressed about the big ticket items where funds are getting allocated, while there are infrastructure needs affecting our local communities are not being prioritized.

Mr. Cooper raised a question to the group about how many are receiving the Opiate Settlement money, and what other townships were using it for. Mr. Campbell and Ms. Brannock shared more details about the Opiate Funds and how strict the restrictions are for its use. Things like Narcan, and drug counseling, education, and enforcement activities. Mr. Hausermann recommended that townships contact their legal counsel for further guidance and information.

Mr. Hausermann asked Ms. Hinnners if she had anything on her Zoning Committee. Ms. Hinnners replied that she had a question. She shared that she has been contacted, but it's been by our associate members, zoning inspectors, from different townships who are interested in talking about zoning and forming a separate group to really look into zoning. Ms. Hinnners points out that on our Constitution we have associate members, but they do not get a vote. She hasn't responded to any of them because she wonders how she can tell them that works for one of the active members how they can be in that. So how can she do that? They are associate members so they should be able to participate in a sub topic, like zoning that's important, that they know a lot about. Mr. Hausermann responded that, when it comes to associates, they can participate but if there is anything that comes to an actual vote it can only be voted on by elected officials. Ms. Hinnners understands that, but these are people that work for other townships, so she wonders are they going to get paid for that or something else. Mr. Hausermann replied that it would be a volunteer basis if they wanted to come in here and chat, but no one is going to force them to.

Mr. Freeman had a couple thoughts on this he wanted to share and would want to have a little clarity on. He said he thinks it's great that these outsiders want to be on the committee, but he wonders would we want to make them have to be associate members to be in the committee. Mr. Freeman asked Mr. Baird what the cost of an associate membership is. Mr. Baird pointed out that we are actually talking about township employees which would be Affiliate memberships, and that the present dues are \$35.00.

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

Mr. Freeman continued that that fact gets to the root of his question: are members comfortable with paying the membership fee for their staff to become affiliate members. Mr. Cooper replied that it would be up to the individual townships whether they wanted to pay for that. Mr. Campbell replied that Union township does, and Mr. Freeman added that Pierce township does as well. Mr. Campbell further shared the benefits that he sees for Affiliate members with the OTA resources that become available to them with their membership.

### **General Discussion:**

Mr. Hausermann stated from that topic, we will now move on to Holiday Toy Drives and Shop w/A Cop programs. He asked Mr. Baird for a recap of what was done last year.

Mr. Baird shared that we donated to four programs last year: the Brewer Foundation with the County Sheriff's Department, Pierce Township, Goshen Township, and Miami Township. We gave \$300 donations to each last year.

Mr. Baird also shared awareness that the Tate Township Fire Department is also accepting cash donations for its toy drive this year. Mr. Baird shared a flyer about their program. Mr. Hausermann asked the group if there was any objection to adding a fifth donation this year. Mr. Cooper asked if we could also add a sixth donation. A member asked why just those four, and Mr. Hausermann replied that the four that we've historically donated to are the ones that have come to us asking for a donation.

Mr. Cooper shared more details about the organization in Washington Township called Community Helpers. They host a visit from Santa Claus, who is scheduled for December 13<sup>th</sup> this year, and they've always had a couple business donate but they are not doing it this year. So, anything that organization could be given would be very much appreciated.

Mr. Hausermann stated that with the addition of the Bethel-Tate Fire Department, and Washington Township Community Helpers, that we would now be at six. At the same level as last year, \$300 each, with six donations we would be at \$1800. Ms. Hinnners asked again how much money we have. Mr. Baird stated \$4,273. A member stated that we maybe should do \$200 instead of \$300, and Ms. Hinnners agreed. Mr. Hausermann agreed that's where he was going with the discussion. Our offset has usually been that our membership fees, what we receive and keep, add up to about \$1000. And if we add those to six, and reduce each donation to \$200, we would only be about \$200 over allocated. Mr. Cooper stated that Washington Township would be happy with \$100, but Mr. Hausermann replied that we should keep it all the same at \$200.

Mr. Hausermann asked if everyone was ok with that. A member stated that we don't spend it on anything else anymore. Mr. Hausermann replied in the affirmative but reminded that we also don't hold any fundraisers anymore either. Ms. Hinnners asked if we were not doing the fair anymore. Mr. Hausermann replied that we haven't done it the past two years primarily due to Covid and the impact it had on organizing such events.

Debate continued about the past donations, reiterating the four we donated to last year, and the question was asked why we don't jump it around. Mr. Hausermann replied that we've been donating to

## **Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes**

Date: 11/20/2025

organizations that come and ask, and if we had other fundraisers that had been brought to us we would probably have had this conversation before now.

Mr. Hausermann reminded us again that we are back to a possible six and if we donate \$200 to each we are at the \$1200 that we've been spending. He asked what the members would like to do. Ms. Hinnners replied that she likes the idea of giving it to the new ones that have asked, and that we need to have a discussion next year on how we are going to spend the money because all townships have needy kids, so they all need consideration, and her point is that every township has some kind of organization of this type. Ms. Hinnners states she's fine with switching it around and having other groups get a donation each time, and that we should be passing it around more.

Mr. Bainum suggested that we should perhaps give \$250 to each of the six this year, and then next year decide if we're going to do a fundraiser to build up our funds.

Mr. Baird shared with the group that we had roughly \$1100 of retained funds from the membership drive. We keep \$10.00 of the membership dues with the balance being sent to the OTA. Mr. Baird reminded that if we donated \$250 to each we are at \$1500 which is roughly \$500 above our revenue.

Mr. Cooper moved to send \$200.00 each to the six identified organizations, and a second was confirmed. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote, and the motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Hausermann stated that future donations are a topic for conversation in 2026.

Mr. Cooper asked a question of the new President if we are keeping the same schedule for meeting next year and to confirm that we are in Batavia in January, Pierce in February, and March is the Board of Health. Mr. Freeman replied yes, we will be keeping roughly the same schedule next year, and that the officers will be meeting in the next couple weeks to discuss next year's schedule and agenda.

Mr. Hausermann stated that it was just brought to his attention that we still need to vote for the Secretary & Treasurer.

Mr. Hausermann opened the floor for nominations for Secretary/Treasurer of the CCTA for 2026. Mr. Cooper nominated Mr. Baird, seconded by Mr. Becker. Mr. Cooper moved to close nominations, seconded by Mr. Becker. Mr. Hausermann called for a voice vote of all in favor to state "Aye", and for all opposed. With one vote in opposition, Mr. Baird was elected by the majority of Active Members present as Secretary/Treasurer of the Clermont County Township Association for 2026.

### **Conclusion:**

Mr. Hausermann called for a motion to adjourn. Mr. Cooper moved to adjourn. A member asked if we could please recognize those newly elected officials present. Mr. Laubach of Washington Township, Mr. Maklem of Williamsburg Township, Mr. Joel Gilpin of Ohio Township, and Mr. Scott Wolf of Ohio Township introduced themselves.

Mr. Hausermann stated he has a motion on the floor adjourn. Mr. Hinson again moved to adjourn, seconded by Mr. Bainum. Meeting adjourned at approximately 7:48 PM.